

Be Smart When Buying a Smartwatch



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Smartwatches have grown from just being a fad to a lifestyle necessity. Makers of smartwatches have pointed out on various occasions that the segment has not grown at the expected pace, but this is likely to change in 2015. Apple Watch is one of the most-awaited devices of the year and is touted to be the device that will make smartwatches mainstream. Google's Android Wear, launched last year especially for wearable devices, is poised to mature and reach to the next level. Year 2015 will also see some of the second-generation smartwatches being launched and an increased interest of developers in the wearables' ecosystem.

Having a smartwatch on your wrist definitely carves a techie-edge for you in your social circle. If you have not purchased a smartwatch till now, it is time you evaluate your choices and consider buying one. But before you do that, here are some tips to help you make an informed choice. Check out this quick smartwatch buying guide before you visit an online or offline store to buy this wearable gadget for yourself.

Device and OS compatibility

As far as the operating system (OS) is

concerned, Android seems to be winning the race here. While Microsoft Band is set to make its mark among users, Apple Watch is yet to make its market debut. However, Android has specialised with Android Wear, a platform specifically designed for wearable devices, apart from Android OS being used in smartwatches by several OEMs. So before you decide, do check the OS compatibility of your existing smartphone with the smartwatch you are interested in buying.

Also, check the compatibility of the smartwatch with your smartphone. For example, Motorola's Moto 360 is compatible with smartphones running Android v4.3 or later. This is the case with all Android Wear smartwatches, including launches from the likes of Samsung and LG. While Sony SmartWatch 2 functions with any smartphone running Android v4.0 or later, Pebble and Pebble Steel work with both Android and iOS devices. Similarly, Microsoft Band is compatible with Android v4.3, iOS and, of course, Windows OS. So if a smartwatch impresses you but is not compatible with your smartphone, it is of not much use.

SOME SMARTWATCHES AVAILABLE IN INDIA

	Kenxinda W1 smartwatch mobile with Bluetooth	MOTA smartwatch for iPhones and Android phones with Bluetooth	Sony smartwatch Mn2	Samsung Galaxy Gear Fit SM-R350 smartwatch fitness tracker	LG G watch	Pebble smart watch
						
Price	₹ 1798	₹ 5690	₹ 6537	₹ 9340	₹ 10,524	₹ 11,998
Features worth looking at	Offers multi-sim and 500mAh battery	Stylish, easy to use and comfortable to wear, with a strap designed for universal wrist sizes	Choice between a digital and an analogue interface, wrist straps available in several colours, any 20mm wrist strap designed to be used with a wristwatch, can be used	Real-time fitness coaching and heart-rate monitoring without sacrificing style or connectivity	Compatible with any smartphone running Android v4.3 and later	Puts useful apps and notifications on your wrist

The prices mentioned here are from various e-commerce portals and are subject to change.